

Chapter 14: Writing with Style

第十四章：文体与风格 (Wéntǐ yǔ fēnggé)

Your Goal for This Chapter 本章目标 (Běn zhāng mùbiāo): To move beyond "correct" writing to "powerful" writing. You will learn to refine your sentences for clarity, concision, and impact, making your arguments more persuasive and professional. 超越“正确”的写作，达到“有力”的写作。你将学习优化句子，使其清晰、简洁、有影响力，从而使你的论证更有说服力、更专业。

Lesson 14.1: The Principles of Powerful Prose

第一课：有力散文的原则 (Yǒulì sǎnwén de yuánzé)

Part 1: Clarity Over Cleverness

清晰胜过巧妙 (Qīngxī shèngguò qiǎomiào)

Your first job is to be understood. Complex ideas demand simple language.

你的首要任务是让人理解。复杂的思想需要简单的语言。

- **Unclear 不清晰:** "The multi-faceted pedagogical methodologies employed therein ultimately obfuscate the fundamental kernel of the intended communicative transmission."
“其中采用的多方面教学方法最终模糊了预期传播的基本核心。”
- **Clear 清晰:** "The teacher's complicated instructions confused the students."
“老师复杂的指令让学生感到困惑。”

Ask yourself 问自己: Could I say this more simply?

我能说得更简单点吗？

Part 2: Conciseness is Confidence

简洁就是自信 (Jiǎnjié jiùshì zìxìn)

Wordy writing is often weak writing. It can sound like you are trying to fill space. Concise writing is strong and confident.

冗长的写作往往是乏力的写作。它听起来像是你在试图填充空间。简洁的写作是有力且自信的。

- **Wordy 冗长:** "Due to the fact that the experiment was conducted in a manner that was not systematic, it is possible that the results are not completely accurate."
“由于实验是以一种不系统的方式进行的，结果可能不完全准确。”
- **Concise 简洁:** "Because the experiment was unsystematic, the results may be inaccurate."
“因为实验不系统，结果可能不准确。”

How to be concise 如何做到简洁:

- Replace long phrases with strong verbs. (e.g., "is indicative of" → "indicates")
用强动词替换长短语。(例如，“is indicative of” → “indicates”)
- Remove redundant words. (e.g., "basic fundamentals," "end result")
删除冗余的词语。(例如，“basic fundamentals,” “end result”)
- Avoid "there is/are" and "it is" when you can start with the subject.
当你可以用主语开头时，避免使用“there is/are”和“it is”。

Lesson 14.2: Surgical Editing - Word and Sentence Level

第二课：精准编辑——词语和句子层面 (Jīngzhǔn biānjí——Cíyǔ hé jùzi céngmiàn)

Part 1: Choosing the Right Tool

选择正确的工具 (Xuǎnzé zhèngquè de gōngjù)

Weak & Vague 弱且模糊	Strong & Precise 强且精确	Why It's Better 为什么更好
"get," "do," "thing," "stuff" “得到”、“做”、“东西”、“事情”	acquire, perform, concept, material 获得、执行、概念、材料	The precise word creates a clearer picture. 精确的词语能创造更清晰的画面。
"very big," "really good" “非常大”、“真的很好”	enormous, immense; excellent, superb 巨大的、无边的；优秀的、极好的	Strong adjectives don't need "very." 强的形容词不需要“非常”。
"She was sad." “她很悲伤。”	"She was despondent." or "Grief weighed on her." “她很沮丧。”或“悲伤压垮了她。”	Specific emotions or metaphors are more powerful. 具体的情感或隐喻更有力。

Part 2: Sentence Surgery 句子手术 (Jùzi shǒushù)

1. Eliminate "Zombie Nouns" 消除“僵尸名词”

Zombie nouns are nouns made from verbs (e.g., utilization, implementation, conceptualization). They drain the life out of your sentences.

僵尸名词是由动词变来的名词（例如：利用、实施、概念化）。它们吸走了你句子的生命力。

- **Before:** "The **implementation** of the plan by the committee..."
“委员会对计划的**实施**...”
- **After:** "The committee **implemented** the plan..."
“委员会**实施**了计划...”

2. Activate the Passive Voice (When Appropriate) 激活被动语态（在适当的时候） **Passive voice 被动语态** Emphasises the action, not the doer. **Active voice 主动语态** is stronger and more direct.

被动语态强调动作，而不是执行者。**主动语态**更强大、更直接。

- **Passive (Weak):** "The treaty was signed by the leaders." (Emphasis on *treaty*)
被动（弱）：“条约被领导人们签署了。”（强调条约）
- **Active (Strong):** "The leaders signed the treaty." (Emphasis on *leaders*)
主动（强）：“领导人们签署了条约。”（强调领导人们）

Use passive voice only when the doer is unknown or unimportant. 仅当执行者未知或不重要时才使用被动语态。

- **Good Passive:** "The solution was heated to 100°C." (Who heated it? The scientist. It's unimportant.)
好的被动：“溶液被加热到100°C。”（谁加热的？科学家。这不重要。）

3. Vary Sentence Structure 变换句子结构

A series of short, simple sentences sounds choppy. A series of long, complex sentences is hard to follow. Mix them.

一连串短小的简单句听起来不连贯。一连串冗长的复杂句很难理解。混合使用。

- **Choppy 不连贯:** "The data was conclusive. The hypothesis was correct. We celebrated. We published the results."
“数据是决定性的。假设是正确的。我们庆祝了。我们发表了结果。”
- **Varied & Better 多变且更好:** "Because the data was conclusive, we knew the hypothesis was correct. After celebrating, we published the results."
“因为数据是决定性的，我们知道假设是正确的。庆祝之后，我们发表了结果。”

Lesson 14.3: The Rhythm of Reading

第三课：阅读的节奏 (Yuèdú de jiézòu)

Part 1: Read It Aloud

大声读出来 (Dàshēng dú chūlái)

The best editing tool is your ear. If you stumble over a sentence while reading it aloud, your reader will stumble while reading it silently.

最好的编辑工具是你的耳朵。如果你大声读一个句子时结巴了，你的读者在默读时也会结巴。

What to listen for 听什么：

- **Awkward phrasing:** Does it sound natural?
awkward 的措辞：听起来自然吗？

- **Long sentences:** Can you say it in one breath? If not, shorten it.
长句：你能一口气说完吗？如果不能，就缩短它。
- **Repetition:** Do you use the same word too many times?
重复：你是否过多地使用了同一个词？

Part 2: The Peer Test

同行测试 (Tóngháng cèshì)

Give your essay to a friend. Ask them to highlight any sentence that:
把你的文章给一个朋友。请他们标出任何：

1. They had to read twice to understand.
他们必须读两遍才能理解的句子。
2. That felt clunky or awkward.
感觉笨拙或 awkward 的句子。
3. Where they lost track of the argument.
他们跟不上论证的句子。

This is invaluable feedback. If one person is confused, others will be too.
这是宝贵的反馈。如果一个人感到困惑，其他人也会如此。

Homework: The Style Editor

作业：文体编辑 (Wéntǐ biānjí)

Task 1: Sentence Makeover

Rewrite the following sentences to make them more concise, active, and clear.
重写下面的句子，使它们更简洁、主动、清晰。

1. **Original:** "It is the opinion of this researcher that a utilisation of more efficient methodologies would be beneficial."
改写: _____
2. **Original:** "There are many reasons why the argument that was made by the author is not a persuasive one."
改写: _____
3. **Original:** "The phenomenon of climate change is one that is having a global impact that is negative on a great number of people."
改写: _____

Task 2: Self-Audit

Take a paragraph from an old essay. Perform a style edit on it.
从一篇旧文章中选一个段落。对其进行文体编辑。

- **Original Paragraph 原始段落:** _____
- **Edited Paragraph 编辑后的段落:** _____
- **Changes Made 所做的修改:** I replaced ____ with ____ to be more concise. I changed a passive verb to an active one. I combined two short sentences. etc.
我所做的修改： 我用 ____ 替换了 ____ 以更简洁。我把一个被动动词改为主动。我合并了两个短句。等等。

Task 3: The Ear Test

Record yourself reading your edited paragraph from Task 2 aloud. Listen to the recording.
录制自己大声朗读任务2中编辑后的段落。听录音。

- **Where did you stumble? 你在哪里卡顿了？** _____
- **How will you fix it? 你将如何修改它？** _____